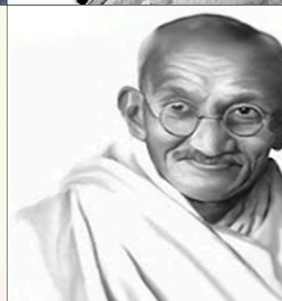
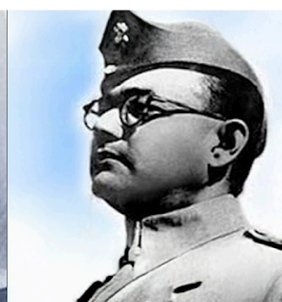


General Knowledge

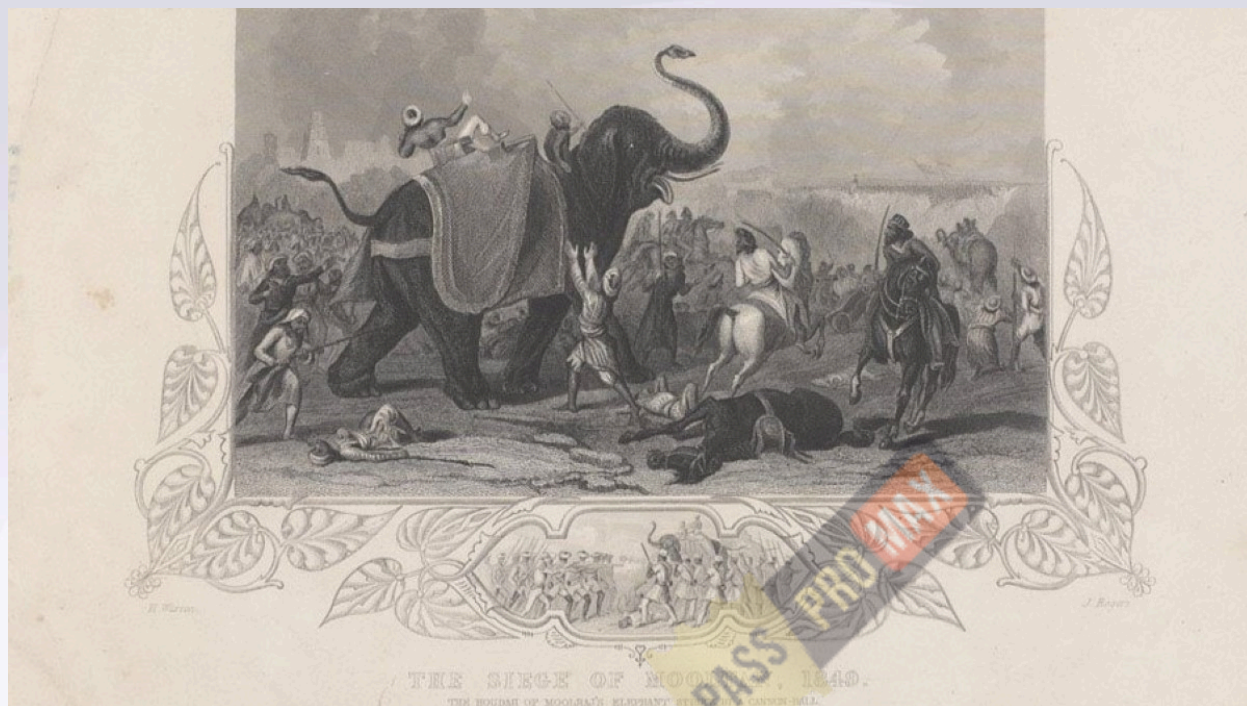
Modern History

STUDY NOTES

**Expansion of British East India Company -
Anglo-Sikh Wars**



Anglo-Sikh Wars (1845-1849)



The Anglo-Sikh Wars were a series of two conflicts fought between the British East India Company and the Sikh Empire in Punjab. These wars ultimately led to the British annexation of Punjab.

Background

- **Rise of the Sikh Empire:** Established by Maharaja Ranjit Singh in the early 19th century, Punjab became a powerful, unified state with a formidable army.
- **British Expansion:** By the 1840s, the British had already annexed vast territories in India and eyed Punjab due to its strategic location.
- **Political Instability in Punjab:** Following the death of Ranjit Singh in 1839, Punjab saw internal strife and instability, making it vulnerable to external threats.

First Anglo-Sikh War (1845-1846)

Timeline

Date	Event
December 1845	First Anglo-Sikh War begins
December 18, 1845	Battle of Mudki – British victory
December 21, 1845	Battle of Ferozeshah – heavy losses on both sides, British victory
January 1846	Battles of Baddowal and Aliwal – British advance
February 10, 1846	Battle of Sobraon – decisive British victory, end of First War
March 9, 1846	Treaty of Lahore – Punjab loses some territories

Key Points

- **Cause:** British desire to control Punjab, weak leadership after Ranjit Singh's death.
- **Major Battles:** Mudki, Ferozeshah, Baddowal, Aliwal, Sobraon.
- **Outcome:** Sikh defeat; Treaty of Lahore signed, British control of some Punjab territories.

Between the Wars (1846-1848)

- **Treaty of Bhairowal (1846):** British gain greater influence over Punjab by assuming control of Sikh administration.
- **Political Interference:** The British stationed a Resident (Henry Lawrence) in Punjab to oversee Sikh affairs, creating resentment among the Sikh populace.

Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-1849)

Timeline

Date	Event
April 1848	Revolt of Diwan Mulraj in Multan
July 1848	British launch offensive against Multan
November 1848	Battle of Ramnagar – inconclusive
January 13, 1849	Battle of Chillianwala – heavy losses, no clear winner
February 21, 1849	Battle of Gujrat – British decisive victory, end of Second War
March 29, 1849	Annexation of Punjab by British

Key Points

- Cause: Growing resentment towards British interference, Diwan Mulraj's rebellion.
- Major Battles: Ramnagar, Chillianwala, Gujrat.
- Outcome: Sikh Empire falls; Punjab becomes a British province.

Takeaways

- Strategic Significance: Punjab's annexation gave the British control over the entire Indian subcontinent.
- Sikh Resistance: Despite internal issues, Sikh forces put up a fierce resistance, showcasing their military skills.

- End of Sikh Sovereignty: The Second War marked the end of Sikh political independence in India.

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